

Set up Claude Code for the team

You are an Owner of your company's Claude organization — the account under which the team uses Claude Code. In this article you set one organization-wide rule: Claude Code shows every file change to the person and waits for their approval before writing it, on every teammate's computer, and the modes that would skip that approval disappear from their Claude Code. Everything happens in the Claude admin console in your browser — nothing to install, no command line. Do it once, before the team starts; people who join later are covered automatically.

FOR	Stage 1 · Owner of your Claude organization	TIME	about 20 minutes, once
VERSION	v4.7 · September 2026 · built 2026-09-04	ALSO ONLINE	Work OS Team Setup site > Setup > Set up Claude Code for the team. <i>Italic names are other articles of that site.</i>

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How this fits with the repository rule

A file change in the Work OS can pass up to three approvals. This article sets up the first; the other two come with the Work OS and with the repository.

Approval	What it protects	Where it is set
Claude Code's approval card — before a file changes, the person sees what will change and accepts or rejects it	Every file, on every computer	The Claude admin console — this article
The 🗝️ GATED FILE note on that card — for the few files that steer the whole Work OS, the card also says why the file is protected and where the change will go	Gated files, on every computer	Ships with the Work OS — nothing to set up
Pull-request approval on <code>main</code> — a gated change reaches the team only when a Work OS admin approves it	Gated files, in the shared repository	Set up the repository , step 4

WHY THIS MATTERS

The console rule is what makes *"a person approves every change"* true for everyday files too — the repository rule only reviews gated files. It also keeps Claude Code's hands-off modes out: on the Team plan, new sessions start in **Auto** by default since August 2026, where a background check approves actions instead of the person, and on any plan a person can switch to Auto or Accept edits unless the organization says otherwise.

Before you start

- ☐ Your company uses Claude on the **Team** or **Enterprise** plan. Individual plans (Pro, Max) have no organization console.
- ☐ You are an **Owner** or **Primary Owner** of the Claude organization. Admins and members can open the console but not its managed settings — if step 1 sends you to a different page, that is why.
- ☐ Everyone on the team signs in to Claude Code with a seat in this organization — the work account from *Set up your computer, step 2*. The policy travels with that sign-in and reaches nobody else.
- ☐ You have agreed with the Work OS admin whether the team may also use Claude Code **on the web** — sessions that run on Anthropic's computers instead of the person's own. Step 2 asks.

Step 1 — Open the Claude Code page of the admin console

- 1 Sign in at claude.ai with your Owner account.
- 2 Open **Admin settings** from the menu under your name, then select **Claude Code** in the left panel — or go straight to claude.ai/admin-settings/claude-code.

EXPECTED

The page shows the organization switches for Claude Code — **Code in the desktop**, **Code in the web**, **Remote Control**, **Disable Bypass permissions mode** — and a **Managed settings** section. If the link lands on another admin page instead, your account isn't an Owner: ask an Owner to do this article.

NOTE

The console evolves — a switch may carry a slightly different name than shown here. Go by what it does, described next to it.

- 4 **Remote Control** — your decision. It lets a person steer a session running on their own computer from their phone or browser; the approval cards appear there too, so it doesn't weaken the rule. It is off by default — leave it unless someone asks for it.

EXPECTED

Bypass permissions disappears from every teammate's mode selector once their Claude Code has picked the policy up — step 4 shows how to check.

Step 3 — Add the file-change policy

The switch above removes Bypass. The rest of the rule — Manual as the starting mode, Auto removed, and an approval card before every file change whatever mode a person picks — is a short settings text. The console sends it to every teammate's Claude Code, which fetches it at start and rechecks every hour.

- 1 Under **Managed settings**, open the settings box — the text field that takes JSON (add or edit).
- 2 Paste the policy below. If the box already holds settings your IT added, keep those and add the two parts — `permissions` and `allowManagedPermissionRulesOnly` — inside the outer braces, so the text stays valid JSON.

MANAGED SETTINGS — THE FILE-CHANGE POLICY

```
{
  "permissions": {
    "defaultMode": "default",
    "disableAutoMode": "disable",
    "disableBypassPermissionsMode": "disable",
    "ask": [
      "Edit",
      "Write",
      "NotebookEdit",
      "Bash(mv *)",
      "Bash(cp *)",
      "Bash(rm *)",
      "Bash(rmdir *)",
      "Bash(sed *)"
    ]
  },
  "allowManagedPermissionRulesOnly": true
}
```

- 3 Select **Save**.

EXPECTED

The console shows the saved settings without an error. Each teammate's Claude Code picks the policy up the next time it starts, or within an hour if it is already open — nothing for them to do.

What each line does

Line	What it does for the team
<code>"defaultMode": "default"</code>	Every new session starts in Manual — Claude shows each file change and each command and waits for a yes. (<code>default</code> is the settings name of Manual.)
<code>"disableAutoMode": "disable"</code>	Removes Auto from everyone's mode selector; a session that would have started in Auto starts in Manual instead.
<code>"disableBypassPermissionsMode": "disable"</code>	The same rule as the switch in step 2, for every place Claude Code runs — terminal, editors and the desktop app alike.
<code>"ask": [...]</code>	The heart of the policy. Claude's three file tools — <code>Edit</code> , <code>Write</code> , <code>NotebookEdit</code> — always ask, even in Accept edits . The five commands after them move, copy, delete or rewrite files; Accept edits would otherwise run them without asking.
<code>"allowManagedPermissionRulesOnly": true</code>	Nobody can weaken the rule from their own settings: personal and project <i>always allow</i> rules are ignored, and the approval card no longer offers <i>don't ask again</i> .

WHY THIS MATTERS

Why not simply limit everyone to Manual? There is no such switch. Auto and Bypass can be removed; **Accept edits** and **Plan** are always in the selector. The `ask` lines make that harmless: a person may still pick Accept edits for a session, and Claude still stops before every file change.

NOTE

A lighter version. If Manual as the default is enough for your team — trusting a person who deliberately switches a session to Accept edits — leave out the `ask` part and keep the rest. Prompts then depend on the mode the person picked.

DON'T

Add `allow` rules for file tools or commands here. They would switch the approval off for everyone at once, and with `allowManagedPermissionRulesOnly` nobody could turn it back on from their own settings.

Step 4 — Check the policy on one computer

Ask one teammate — or use your own computer — to confirm the policy arrived. Everything happens in the Claude Code desktop app; no terminal needed.

- 1 Quit and reopen the Claude Code desktop app, sign in with the organization account, and start a session in the Work OS folder.

EXPECTED

The mode selector next to the send button shows **Manual**, and its menu offers Manual, Accept edits and Plan only — no Auto, no Bypass permissions.

- 2 Ask Claude for a harmless everyday change and accept it when the card appears:

SAY TO CLAUDE

“Create a short test note at product-development/product/meetings/other/summaries/<today's date>-policy-test.md and mark it clearly as TEST”

EXPECTED

Before anything is written, an approval card shows the file and its content; Claude waits for your yes. Only then does the file exist.

- 3 Switch the mode selector to **Accept edits** and ask for another change:

SAY TO CLAUDE

“Add one more line to that test note”

EXPECTED

The approval card appears again — that is the ask part at work. Without it, Accept edits would write the change silently. Switch back to **Manual**.

- 4 Ask Claude to change a gated file — and reject it, this is only a test:

SAY TO CLAUDE

“In business-info.md, correct or fill in one line”

EXPECTED

The approval card carries the Work OS's  **GATED FILE** note: why the file is protected and where an approved change would go. After a reject, nothing is written.

Chat

Cowork

Code

WORK-OS

Policy test

Access test

Weekly review

Tier discount PRD

Policy test · Documents/work-os · Local

Create a short test note at product-development/product/meetings/other/summaries/2026-09-04-policy-test.md and mark it clearly as TEST

I'll create the test note. Here is the file I want to write:

2

Write file

product-development/product/meetings/other/summaries/2026-09-04-policy-test.md

+ # TEST — policy test note

+ Date: 2026-09-04 · Created to check the organization's Claude Code rule.

+ Safe to delete.

Do you want to make this change?

Accept

Reject

1

PERMISSION MODE

Manual

asks before every change ✓

Accept edits

file edits still ask — organization rule

Plan

read and plan, no edits

Auto · Bypass-permissions — removed by your organization

Manual

Model

Claude Code desktop app, Code tab — layout simplified. The live app may differ in detail.

① the mode selector without Auto and Bypass · ② the approval card before a file change

What the teammate sees — a schematic, not a screenshot: the mode selector without Auto and Bypass permissions, and the approval card before a file change.

TIP

Only from a terminal: to see which policy a computer follows, someone with a terminal runs `claude doctor` and reads the *Managed settings (remote)* line, or `/status` in a terminal session, whose *Setting sources* line reads *Enterprise managed settings (remote)*. The checks above show the same without one.

TIP

Clean-up: ask Claude to delete the test note.

Step 5 — Tell the team

1 Tell the Work OS admin the policy is in place. In Stage 3 they tell users what to expect: every file change shows an approval card, and Auto and Bypass permissions are gone by design — not a fault.

2 People who join later need nothing: the policy is tied to the organization, not to a computer.

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YOU'RE DONE WHEN

One teammate's Claude Code starts in Manual, offers neither Auto nor Bypass permissions, and shows an approval card before every file change — even in Accept edits. The Claude side of Stage 1 is complete; the repository side is [Set up the repository](#). Stage 2 continues with [Set up your computer](#).

If IT manages the team's devices

The console is the right place for most companies: nothing to deploy, and the policy reaches every computer where a person signs in with the organization account — new ones included. IT teams that already manage devices (Jamf, Intune, Group Policy) can deliver the same policy text as a device policy instead. That is a stronger guarantee — a person can't edit it without administrator rights — but it doesn't reach sessions on Anthropic's computers. Both can coexist: the console version is used whenever it delivers a policy. The device paths and formats are in Anthropic's guide, [Deploy managed settings](#).

What the policy does not cover

- **It is a setting, not a lock.** In Anthropic's words, console-managed settings are a client-side control, not a security boundary: on a computer IT doesn't manage, a determined person can get around them. That is why the Work OS keeps the repository rule on `main` from [Set up the repository](#) — gated files reach the team only through an approved pull request, whatever happens on a computer.
- **Other sign-ins.** A person who signs in with an API key or through a company gateway to Amazon Bedrock, Google Cloud or Microsoft Foundry doesn't receive the console's policy. [Set up your computer](#) signs everyone in with the organization account, so this only matters if someone changes that.
- **The Cowork tab.** The policy governs the Code tab of the Claude desktop app, where the Work OS runs. Cowork sessions on the same computer don't receive the console's settings.
- **People, not tools.** The policy binds Claude Code only. Someone editing repository files in a text editor isn't asked — and needn't be: they are the person.

Changing the policy later

Open the same page, edit the settings text, save. Every teammate's Claude Code picks the change up at its next start or within the hour. Removing a line loosens the rule for everyone at once, so treat a change like any gated change: agree it with the Work OS admin first.

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